



Luke Michaels

Web Designer & Developer

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SUMMARY

Web developer and designer with 15+ years building fast, accessible websites and the design systems behind them. I cover the full front end: design, reusable component libraries, and production HTML, CSS, and JavaScript. Recent work has centered on WordPress and React, with a long focus on performance, accessibility, and building tools non-technical teams can run without a developer.

CORE SKILLS

Front-end development, design systems and component libraries, web performance and Core Web Vitals, WCAG accessibility, Figma and prototyping, UX and interaction design, WordPress and React, usability testing, working with non-technical stakeholders.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Web Developer & UX Designer

Mercy For Animals

09/17 to 11/25 | Remote / Portland, OR

Ran front-end development and UX for a global advocacy organization with millions of annual visitors. Built and maintained the design system, owned performance and accessibility, and worked closely with the content and program staff who manage the site day to day.

- Built a reusable component library that lets 20+ non-technical staff put campaign pages together on their own. Launch times dropped from about two weeks to three days, with roughly 30% less developer involvement.
- Owned the design system and a library of 100+ ACF Pro blocks, plus the contribution standards and documentation that kept it consistent as the team grew.
- Took the public site to WCAG 2.1 AA and 95%+ Lighthouse accessibility scores. That meant semantic markup, real keyboard and focus handling, ARIA where it counted, and testing with actual screen readers.

- Cut bounce rates by 15 to 20% on key landing pages. One piece of that was a custom mobile slider with GPU-accelerated animation that still worked with assistive tech.
- Improved Core Web Vitals (LCP, INP, CLS) by up to 40%, moving mobile PageSpeed scores from the 60s into the 90s through asset optimization, code-splitting, and caching.
- Built A/B-test-ready CTA components that shipped across several international campaigns and cut deployment time by about 50%.
- Refactored legacy code and paid down technical debt, which cut onboarding time for new engineers by about 25%.
- Ran design reviews with product, content, and leadership, and trained non-technical staff on the system so design stayed consistent without leaning on a developer.

Front-End Developer & UX Designer

DHX Advertising

02/16 to 09/17 | Portland, OR

- Built responsive front ends from design mockups for regional and national marketing clients.
- Developed custom WordPress and Drupal sites: themes, templates, reusable components, and CSS animation, with mobile in mind from the start.
- Kept sites fast, accessible, and search-friendly across devices.

Web Designer & Front-End Developer

Needmore Designs

11/15 to 02/16 | Portland, OR

- Designed and built sites for artisan and boutique brands, with custom CMS setups their non-technical owners could manage themselves.
- Handled the responsive front-end work, from CSS animation to the content-editing experience.

Web Designer & Developer

Conscious Box

10/13 to 11/15 | Portland, OR

- Designed marketing pages, subscription onboarding, and email campaigns for a subscription box company.
- Built and A/B tested landing pages that raised conversion rates.
- Kept the brand consistent across web, print, email, and social.

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Bob's Red Mill Natural Foods

04/11 to 10/13 | Milwaukie, OR

- Reworked navigation and checkout on Magento and WooCommerce storefronts.
- Designed product pages, promotional graphics, and merchandising assets, and worked on SEO and site performance.

Earlier Roles (2005 to 2011):

Web design and front-end development at agencies and studios including Off The Wall Media, Print Time, LineDrive, and Title Boxing. Websites, interactive features, and brand assets.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Personal Portfolio & Dashboard | React, Next.js, Framer Motion

Portfolio site built with React and Next.js, with Framer Motion animation and a 100/100 Lighthouse performance score.

Nutty Narrows Thrift Shop | React, TypeScript, Redux, API Integration

Accessible informational site in React and TypeScript, with custom animations, page transitions, and global UI state in Redux.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Front-End: HTML5, CSS3/Sass, JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, React, Vue, Tailwind, Bootstrap, Webpack, Vite

CMS & Platforms: WordPress (custom themes, ACF Pro blocks, Gutenberg), Drupal, Magento, WooCommerce

Backend & Infrastructure: Node.js, PHP, MySQL, Git/GitHub, Google Cloud, AWS, Cloudflare

Performance & Accessibility: Core Web Vitals, asset optimization, code-splitting, caching; WCAG 2.1 AA, semantic HTML, keyboard and focus patterns, ARIA, screen reader testing, color contrast

Design Systems: Component library ownership, contribution standards, documentation, style guides, pattern libraries

Design & UX: User research, wireframing, high-fidelity prototyping, interaction design, information architecture, usability testing, journey mapping

Design Tools: Figma, Illustrator, Photoshop, After Effects, InDesign, Blender

EDUCATION

A.S. in Computer Science & Digital Media
Full Sail University | Orlando, FL

